or find another way to push states to carry out DISCOM reforms

BOOSTING ENERGY CAPACITY Globally, India is already the third largest producer and consumer of power with an installed capacity of 430 GW as of 2023-end. It now has ambitious plans to add another 500 GW by 2031-32. Investments are needed to augment transmission capacities

BACK TO FOSSIL FUELS The surge in electricity demand has led to a simultaneous increase in demand for coal and natural gas. In fact, Coal India could shatter all records in procurement this year. The power ministry will have to ensure uninterrupted supply to thermal power stations

ELECTRICITY ACT The 2024 amendments to the Electricity Act, which takes steps on 'delicensing' and empowers customers and private producers who set up captive plants, should shake up the power sector

Minister of State



SHRIPAD YESSO NAIK, *71* | BJP

EVERGREEN Six-time MP from North Goa, Naik is among the few BJP parliamentarians from the Vajpayee era who continue to be relevant in national politics

HOUSING & URBAN AFFAIRS

SORTING THE URBAN LOGJAM

The ministry will have to revive projects that are in a limbo, such as Smart Cities, while also working to introduce sustainable urban mobility solutions

By AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR

Formerly known as the urban development ministry, the ministry of housing and urban affairs executes a multitude of welfare programmes for the Modi government. The first decision of the new government was to construct more houses under the PM Awas Yojana (PMAY), the urban part of which his ministry handle. There is also Modi's pet scheme, the Swachh Bharat Mission, the scheme for loans to street vendors, the AMRUT cities mission, Smart Cities, the list is long. The ministry also oversees governance of laws pertaining to real estate (through the Real Estate Regulatory Authority or RERA), and also leads the Centre's side in urban metro rail projects that have central funding. ■

MANOHAR LAL KHATTAR
Minister of Housing & Urban Affairs

Minister of State



TOKHAN SAHU, *54* | BJP

OBC FACE Born in Chhattisgarh's Mungeli district, Sahu, an OBC, served as the parliamentary secretary in Raman Singh's government. Represents Bilaspur constituency

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

Delivery of central schemes PMAY is on track, but schemes that incentivise states to connect houses with basic services like sanitation and water, the AMRUT mission for instance, need more push. Ditto with the Affordable Rental Housing scheme and the much-touted Smart Cities Mission

Urban flooding Khattar has said this will be a top priority for him. Alongside, he also has to ensure that city infrastructure planning and management have climate resilience built into them

Sustainable mobility The Centre needs to work to improve urban transport connectivity across India and also provide green mobility options